

FlowSync – Incident Response Policy

1. Overview

This document defines the incident response policy for FlowSync, a B2B SaaS productivity platform. It provides standardized guidelines for identifying, classifying, escalating, and communicating system incidents.

It ensures consistent handling of outages and service disruptions across engineering, support, and AI-driven support systems.

2. Incident Severity Levels

Incidents are classified into four severity levels based on business impact.

P0 – Critical Incident

Definition: Complete system outage or severe service degradation affecting all users.

Examples:

- Platform completely down
- Authentication service failure
- Payment system outage

Response Time:

- Immediate response (0–15 minutes)

Action:

- Full engineering escalation
- Incident war room activated

- Continuous monitoring and updates
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P1 – High Severity Incident

Definition: Major feature is unavailable or significantly degraded affecting a large number of users.

Examples:

- Dashboard not loading
- API timeout affecting multiple services
- Slack integration failure across users

Response Time:

- Within 30 minutes

Action:

- Engineering team notified
 - Partial service mitigation
 - Regular updates every 1 hour
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P2 – Medium Severity Incident

Definition: Partial functionality failure affecting limited users or non-critical features.

Examples:

- Delayed notifications
- Minor UI bugs
- File sync delays

Response Time:

- Within 4 hours

Action:

- Assigned to engineering queue
 - Fix scheduled in upcoming patch or hotfix
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P3 – Low Severity Incident

Definition: Minor issues, cosmetic bugs, or user-specific problems.

Examples:

- UI misalignment
- Feature confusion
- Minor performance lag

Response Time:

- Within 1–3 business days

Action:

- Logged for backlog
 - Addressed in scheduled release cycle
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3. Incident Escalation Rules

3.1 Automatic Escalation Triggers

- System-wide outage detection → P0 escalation
- Repeated API failures across multiple regions → P1 escalation
- Authentication system failures → immediate escalation

3.2 Manual Escalation Triggers

- Customer-reported critical business impact
- SLA breach risk detected
- Enterprise customer escalation request

3.3 Escalation Flow

1. Incident detected (monitoring system or support agent)
 2. Severity classification assigned
 3. Ticket created automatically
 4. Engineering team notified
 5. Incident lead assigned
 6. Status updates initiated
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4. Customer Communication Guidelines

4.1 General Principles

- Be transparent and timely
 - Avoid technical jargon in customer messages
 - Provide estimated resolution time when possible
 - Update customers regularly during incidents
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4.2 Communication Templates

P0 Incident Template

"We are currently experiencing a critical issue affecting FlowSync services. Our engineering team is actively working to resolve the problem. We will provide updates as soon as more information is available."

P1 Incident Template

"We are aware of an issue impacting some FlowSync features. Our team is investigating and working on a fix. We appreciate your patience and will share updates shortly."

P2 Incident Template

"We are currently investigating a partial service issue affecting some users. The core platform remains operational."

P3 Incident Template

"Thank you for reporting this issue. Our team has logged it and will address it in an upcoming update."

5. Outage Handling Behavior

5.1 Detection

- Monitoring systems detect anomalies in latency, error rates, or downtime
- AI system can classify incidents based on logs and user reports

5.2 Mitigation Steps

- Enable fallback services if available
- Route traffic away from affected components
- Disable non-critical features temporarily

5.3 Recovery Process

- Validate system stability
 - Gradual traffic restoration
 - Post-incident review initiated
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6. Post-Incident Process

After resolution of a major incident:

- Root cause analysis (RCA) is performed
 - Incident report is documented
 - Preventive measures are defined
 - Monitoring rules are updated
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7. AI System Usage (Agentic Integration)

This policy is used by AI agents to:

- Detect system-wide vs user-specific issues
 - Classify incident severity automatically
 - Decide escalation level (P0-P3)
 - Generate customer communication messages
 - Trigger engineering alerts and ticket creation
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